



THE 2025 SEASON SAW 7,030 RUNS SCORED – WELL AHEAD OF THE 6,000-ODD FROM THE FIRST TWO EDITIONS. WICKETS WERE JUST AS FREQUENT, WITH 287 FALLING THIS YEAR – AT LEAST 15 MORE THAN PREVIOUS SEASONS



STATFILE

200+ totals in the WPL by season

2023: 4

2024: 0

2025: 5

picked good players, and that's why every game has been this tough. Barely a game or two has been one-sided. We've had so many matches go into the last over. I am happy the level of competition has increased, particularly with the domestic cricketers involved."

New era

The 2025 season saw 7,030 runs scored — well more than the 6,000-odd from the first two editions. Wickets were just as frequent, with

287 falling this year — at least 15 more than previous seasons.

But the WPL is no longer just a stepping stone to the national team. For many domestic players, it has become a standalone career goal.

Take Arundhati Reddy, for example. The financial security from the WPL allowed her to switch domestic teams, giving her better playing opportunities. For Shikha Pandey — whose absence from the Indian team remains unexplained — the league offers a stage to showcase her skill. She has become India's first true globe-trotting cricketer, playing in the WBBL, WCPL, and domestic leagues in Australia and New Zealand to keep her career alive.

Former India captain and broadcaster Mithali Raj believes the WPL has also reshaped the domestic cricket landscape.

"The mindset is changing. There is

Clutch performer: England all-rounder Nat Sciver-Brunt was named Player of the Tournament.

EMMANUAL YOGINI

something to play for in the domestic, just not the championship itself. One thing I've realised is everyone loves being on TV, being recognised. Now, players know if they do well, they may be scouted or picked for trials and potentially be picked by a franchise. There's a lot more at stake. Even if you don't make the Indian team, there is an



equally visible avenue for you to play and earn as well."

She also pointed out the growing confidence among Indian players, highlighting names like Niki Prasad, who thrived under pressure.

However, Mithali acknowledged that the WPL still relies heavily on overseas players — a challenge that will take time to overcome.

"For an overseas player or an international player, this is not the topmost level of the game. There are domestic uncapped players in the mix too, and for them to catch up to the standards of an elite athlete is going to take time. The dependency is there, no doubt, but definitely not as much as the first season. The league is young, it can only get better as we go on."

Out of the shadows

Seven days after MI lifted the trophy at the Brabourne Stadium, the women's central contracts were